

# **USUCGER Annual Meeting**

## **MINUTES**

**Thursday March 18, 2021**

**ZOOM**

**11:00 AM Pacific Time**

Adda Athanasopoulos-Zekkos, USUCGER President, Presiding

### **Attendance:**

- Adda Athanasopoulos-Zekkos (President), Tong Qui (Treasurer) Matt Evans, Kristin Sample-Lord (Webmaster), Gretchen Bohnhoff, and Bret Lingwall (Secretary).
- Also, in attendance were 21 unique USUCGER members

### **Welcome:**

- Call to Order at 11:00 AM
- Introductions of all the board members

### **General Committee Business:**

- Elections will be held for 4 board positions in the Fall of 2021 to have 8 board members.
- Outgoing members were recognized and thanked
- A 2022 USUCGER research workshop is being organized to be collocated with GeoCongress

### **Treasurer's Report:**

- Dues drive is underway. We are on track for 90% responsiveness, but at 60% right now. Please make sure that your dues are paid!
  - 450 total members at 140 institutions plus 40 associate members
- Approximately \$42k in the bank and in pay-pal
- Incomes and Expenses were summarized
  - Dues collected: \$22,500
  - Special Project funded: \$5,000 to Dr. Daniel VandenBerge, TTU
  - Webmaster and Treasurer Honoraria: \$1,500

### **Webmaster's Report:**

- Please reach out to Kristin if you are not getting email updates
- Website has had 9,000 visits to the website, with most visits going to the academic postings page.
- Don't forget that USUCGER has many helpful tools and resources on the website that are available for free for the beneficial use of the membership.
  - Contact the webmaster for password, if you need the password to the teaching materials.
- Website is being updated soon. A major project is underway for the website update.

### **Additional Business:**

- Special projects update
  - New award to TTU on critical thinking skills
  - Past special project: Dr. Fawad Niazi – Geotechnical Education Modelers
    - An update on the project was presented to the membership.
- Awards
  - The following awards were made, and the awardees were recognized by the USUCGER membership:
  - Early Career Researchers: Brett Maurer and Brina Mortensen Montoya
  - Distinguished Service: Jean-Louis Briaud and Richard Frigaszy
- GI board updates were given by Brad Keelor
  - IFCEE will be a blended online-in person conference, with free registration for paper presentation ONLY joining online
  - GEOEXTREME will be moved from August to November, final dates pending
  - Scour and Erosion 2021 will be 100% virtual in October 2021 (the 17<sup>th</sup> through the 20<sup>th</sup>)
  - Nominations for SOA/SOP lectures for GeoCongress 2022 are still being accepted
  - GeoCongress 2023 planning has started.
- GeoCoalition updates from DFI's Theresa Engler
  - DFI is very active throughout the pandemic. There are several upcoming hybrid online in-person conferences coming up through DFI.
  - USUCGER members need to remember (or know) that DFI has many resources for students and educators under the banner of "Groundwork."
- Mentoring Initiative and Associated Ad-hoc Committee
  - The ad-hoc committee plays matchmaker for junior faculty who seek a mentor through USUCGER
  - The initiative is to prioritize diversity in a very broad sense, even in research area
  - Webmaster will place new folks who join USUCGER with the ad-hoc committee
  - The initiative will include
    - On boarding materials
    - Informal networking events at conferences
    - Facilitate speaking and seminar opportunities
  - Expected outcomes include
    - Clarity in navigating the pitfalls of the path to and through tenure, especially for faculty at smaller schools or in departments with very small geo-groups (or even when no other Geotech on campus).
    - This is especially needed, as the vast majority of member institutions have only 1 or 2 geo-faculty

#### **Questions and Comments from the Membership:**

- Professor Jean-Louis Briaud suggested the mentoring initiative not be simply a 1:1 match, but more broad than that.
- He also has teaching lectures and videos available that can be shared with USUCGER and placed on the website. Kristin to contact him separately on the matter.

#### **Adjourn at 12:45 AM after a Motion and Second**